

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an American newspaper:

Instant noodles have changed the world

When Japanese businessman Momofuku Ando died in January 2007, *The New York Times* devoted a page to a man who had earned “a place in the history of human progress”. This was not an inventor who had helped create the bullet train or an electronics firm that had grown to become the envy of every developed economy. He had perfected the humble dish of instant noodles.



His creation – 60 years ago this August – remains unmistakable around the world and even more so than brands like Sony, Honda or Sharp, which represent Japan’s recovery from the Second World War.

Ando watched his wife frying dinner and he realised that frying noodles quickly would remove the water they contained. The noodles could then be stored and when boiling water was added, the dry noodles would be ready to eat. He released the first packet of pre-cooked instant noodles in 1958. They were a huge hit straight away because they were quick, cheap and convenient.

Ando sought out new markets and travelled to the US in 1966 looking at ways of selling instant noodles to Americans and that prompted Ando’s second idea – to sell the noodles in a cup that was easy for anyone to eat.

Today, 100 billion portions of instant noodles are eaten around the world every year, all of this despite increasing concerns that instant noodles contain too much salt and chemical additives and are bad for the environment.

Your school is holding an exhibition on inventions that changed the world. Your group is thinking about including instant noodles in the exhibition. You may want to talk about:

- why instant noodles are popular
- whether instant noodles should be included in the exhibition
- other inventions that could be included
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like instant noodles?
2. Do you often eat fast food?
3. Should students be allowed to eat any food they like at school?
4. Which fast food would you choose to represent Hong Kong?
5. Should the school tuck shop sell instant noodles?
6. Does eating instant noodles encourage poor eating habits?
7. Can students learn from past inventions?
8. What are the qualities of a successful inventor?